

Scott Kellum

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To the hiring committee

Thank you for the opportunity to apply for the Head of Product Design role at Courtyard.io. As a proven design and technology leader with 20 years of experience, I bring a unique combination of strategic vision, hands-on craft, and data-driven execution that aligns perfectly with Courtyard's mission to revolutionize the collectibles experience.

My background spans the full spectrum of product design leadership—from founding and scaling Typetura as CEO to leading cross-functional teams at high-growth companies. At Mariana Tek, I exemplified the collaborative leadership approach Courtyard seeks: working closely with sales, research, product, and engineering teams to navigate complex platform challenges and deliver elegant solutions. By implementing a comprehensive design system and leveraging data-informed design decisions, I increased product velocity 3x and helped grow the business from national to global scale, culminating in a successful acquisition by Xplor.

What excites me most about Courtyard is the opportunity to shape intuitive experiences across genuinely complex problem spaces. My experience creating revenue-generating products, like the Concert Ad Platform at Vox Media that drove over \$20 million annually, demonstrates my ability to balance user delight with business outcomes. I've consistently delivered polished, high-impact launches while building design practices that scale.

My technical depth—including patents in UI innovation and expertise across platforms—enables me to collaborate effectively with engineering teams and push the boundaries of what's possible in digital experiences. Whether contributing CSS specifications to the W3C or mentoring students from Apple, McKinsey, and Google at Cooper Union, I stay at the forefront of design and technology innovation.

I'm energized by Courtyard's remote-first culture and the opportunity to build a design team that can execute at the pace of a fast-growing startup while maintaining the craft and quality that creates truly memorable experiences. I look forward to discussing how my leadership approach and proven track record of scaling design organizations can contribute to Courtyard's continued growth and success.

Warm regards,
Scott Kellum